

the premium households. In short, JioCinema wants to be everything, everywhere, all at once.

Per MPA, to make sure it maintains its growth and scale in the absence of IPL, the platform is all set to scale up in terms of content. "The next 6-12 months will remain critical as platforms strive to balance monetisation and profitability against content investments," says Shah. Experts also point out that JioCinema's annual pricing is at the lower end. While Disney+ Hotstar, Amazon Prime Video and Netflix are all priced in the range of ₹1,000-2,000 annually, Jio has stuck to the less-than-₹1,000 mark. Despite that, a report from Elara Capital states there will not be any large-scale paid subscriber base coming to Jio anytime soon as Indian

JIO WILL HAVE TO OFFER MORE BUNDLED CONTENT TO ACHIEVE SCALE

audiences are value-driven and may not pay only for HBO/Warner Bros. content. Jio, the report adds, will have to offer more bundled content to achieve scale.

Jio will also be able to leverage its telecom and broadband subscriber base. "It may bundle the HBO/Warner Bros. content free for its premium JioFiber or postpaid mobile subscribers," says Karan Taurani, Senior VP at Elara Capital.

He adds that SVOD will grow in India by offering bundled SVOD, with factors like password sharing, quality of content, number of devices per account, ad-free content, transactional video-on-demand and mobile-only plans taken into account. Only then will platforms be able to make a significant headway into India's large market. **BT**

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Progress Pangs

With daily order volumes rising on the network, ONDC is looking for ways to sustain the momentum

BY BINU PAUL



AI-GENERATED IMAGE BY VISHAL GHAVRI

► IN A REMARKABLE display of progress, the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC) has witnessed a 100x increase in orders within a month, with daily order volumes hitting 20,000-25,000. But, the network confronts many challenges in sustaining its growth momentum.

For instance, it recently announced new caps on incentives for seller apps. A senior executive from a partner app says the limits were imposed as the network had exhausted its monthly budget for incentives, driven by a rapid surge in orders. The revision has now led to a significant decline in orders for network participants. "The drop has been significant. ONDC was not ready for this scale. It is now fixing its issues... to get ready for the next wave," he says.

People working with buyer apps have confirmed the drop in orders, with some seeing a decline of up to 50 per cent, compared to peak order volumes. While ONDC has released a new incentive structure to bring back the momentum, network participants find the revised incentive struc-

ture too complex to implement and communicate to consumers.

"The revised incentive construct is very complex. Earlier it was flat, where ONDC would fund the logistics part with ₹75 per order, and everybody offered free delivery. The revised plan still promises free delivery, but for each seller app, it is capped at a fixed amount," said another network participant. "Now buyer apps are not sure how soon it will get exhausted and are unable to run a campaign based on it."

Meanwhile, ONDC is working on an easier incentives structure, likely to be released soon. The upcoming Version 2.0 is expected to fix many issues, to improve delivery times, returns, conflict resolution, etc. Heightened awareness about the network, robust marketing by leading buyer apps, and the imminent launch of Version 2.0 to address specific issues, along with the introduction of additional functionalities and more participants, are expected to fuel the network's growth momentum. **BT**

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